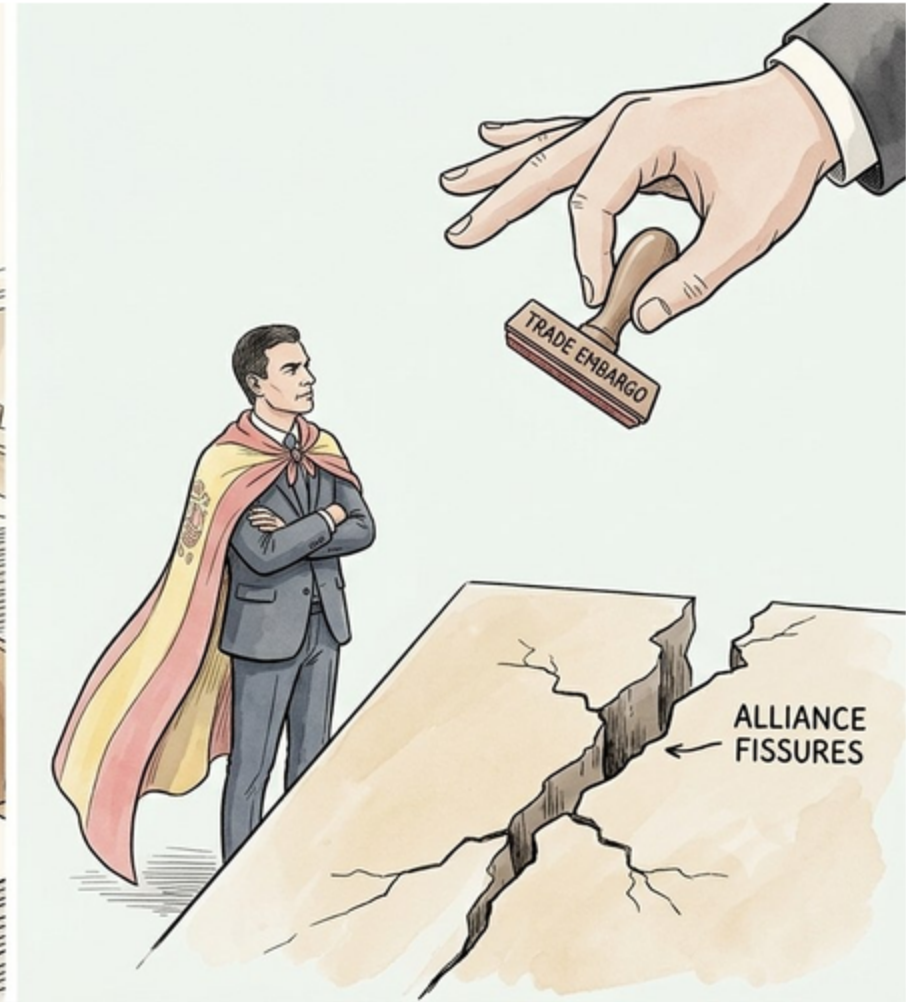


FRONTION NEWS

Defense Brief

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July 11, 2026



NATO Ankara Summit Delivers \$50B+ in Defense Deals, Trump Targets Spain Over Spending

The Bottom Line

The 2026 NATO Ankara summit produced real procurement commitments — over \$50 billion in defense deals, €70 billion for Ukraine, and specific orders for Triton UAVs, GlobalEye aircraft, and A400M projects — but the cracks showed: Trump's trade embargo threat against Spain over defense spending, the Czech opt-out from the Ukraine package, and a final declaration that conspicuously dropped the 5% GDP language. On the technology front, the Pentagon is putting serious money behind directed energy (\$847M for laser weapons) and affordable hypersonics (Castelion's sub-\$300K missile for the Navy), signaling that the next generation of weapons will need to be producible at scale, not just technologically exquisite. Ukraine's Patriot license is a strategic signal — integrating Kyiv into the Western defense industrial base — but it won't produce interceptors for years, leaving the current air-defense gap unaddressed.